

- Whether the computer can work without the Operating System(O.S)
- No.(modern computer)

Let us see why?

Whenever we are switching on the computer what it will do?

It will read the content of ROM and do accordingly. After finishing the POST it will hand over the charge to the RAM. Now we can start to give instruction to the computer.



If we want to interact with the computer, we are in need of a language. Without a language we cannot give even single instruction or interact with the computer.

i.e., the speciality of computer.

If so, I need a language. Where are they?

- They all in external memory. To select a particular language, we have to give a command to the computer. But, even that particular command should also be in one particular language. Now, I don't have any language on my hand.
- Everything is get locked in the external memory, then, what can we do?

A family of rats are living in a house and there is a CAT also. The cat catches a rat per day, as its food. Due to this the rats are so worried and decided to find a solution. They conversed a meeting. While on discussion a rat says, let we tie a bell on the cat neck. So that on getting the bell sound we could run away. Yes good idea, all the other rats appreciate that particular rat. It brought a rope and a bell and asks other rats., come-on go and tie the bell. Each rat is asking other rat to perform the task. Now the rats realised that they cannot able to execute the task on their own.

A Rat can tie the bell to the CAT, when only a third person helps them.

- In order to understand this, let me try to explain you through an old story.

Now our situation is also the same. In order to bring any one of the language from the external memory, someone has to help us. Here, that particular helping hand is this Operating System.

If it so …whether it is a hardware or a software?

- **Absolutely it is software.**

If it is software, it should be stored in a particular memory permanently. Permanent in the sense, it should be stored only in external memory. So, whenever we are switching on the computer, this operating system which is normally in the hard disk should be loaded to the RAM, to serve the user instruction.

Whether it can be loaded automatically to the RAM? Certainly, Not. If so where would be the command? It should be in ROM. After performing the POST the next command is to seek the hard disk (or any external memory) in the computer and to search for operating system program.

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